

Week 10 Interim:

AI-Assisted Triage Urgency Messages

The interface uses four urgency levels: Critical, High, Medium and Low. Each message uses plain language, an action verb and a clear indication of what the nurse should do next. Colour is used as a supporting visual cue rather than the sole indicator of urgency.

● CRITICAL = ACT NOW: Assess this patient immediately.

This means that the patient requires immediate attention.

● HIGH = ASSESS SOON: Prioritise this patient for assessment.

Communicates that the patient should be assessed promptly.

● MEDIUM = REVIEW: Assess this patient when available.

Communicates that the patient requires review but is not the highest priority.

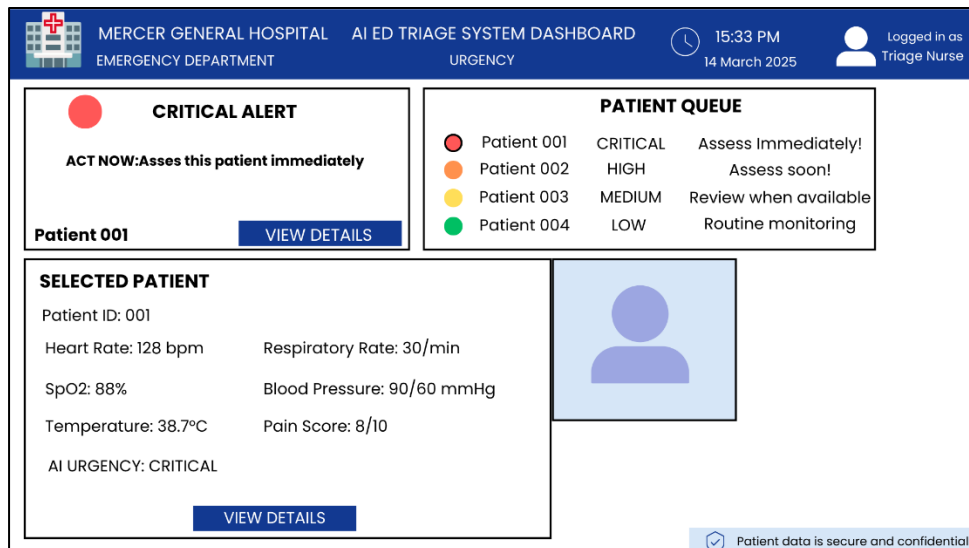
● LOW = MONITOR: Continue routine triage and monitoring.

Communicates that routine monitoring and triage should continue.

Initial HCI Prototype ED Triage Dashboard

Purpose:

The prototype illustrates how an AI-assisted triage system could communicate patient urgency to a triage nurse through a screen-based interface.



The prototype includes:

1. Patient queue - displays patients awaiting assessment.
2. Urgency indicator - identifies the urgency level of each patient.
3. Alert banner - displays the most important AI-generated recommendation.
4. View Details button - allows the nurse to access additional patient information.
5. Patient information panel - provides relevant physiological information supporting the alert.

Accessibility Considerations for the HCI Prototype

The interface is designed for use in a busy emergency-department environment where users may be working under time pressure and fatigue.

1. Colour blindness
 - Concern: Users may not be able to distinguish urgency levels based on colour alone.
 - Design response:
Each alert contains a written urgency label, **CRITICAL**, **HIGH**, **MEDIUM** or **LOW**, as well as an explicit action message. Colour

therefore provides an additional cue rather than being the only source of information.

2. Cognitive load

- Concern: A triage nurse may be working under pressure, particularly during a busy or late shift. Long or complicated messages could slow interpretation.
- Design response: Alert messages are short, use plain language and begin with a clear action. The interface presents the most important information prominently rather than requiring the user to read large amounts of text.

3. Screen Readability

- Concern: Small text, poor contrast or a cluttered interface could make important information difficult to identify quickly.
- Design response: The prototype uses large headings, clear visual separation, readable text and a consistent layout. Urgency information is placed prominently so that it can be identified quickly.

Peer Testing Plan

Tester	Correct ranking?	Unclear message?	Colour helpful?	Suggested improvement
Tester 1				
Tester 2				
Tester 3				